To Reviewer 1

Thank you very much for your incredibly detailed review on our paper and the many great suggestions on how to improve the paper. We did our best to address your concerns in the revised version. Below, we reproduce your comments (in black) and provide our answers in blue.

1. Are the objectives and the rationale of the study clearly stated?

Reviewer #1: Yes — The objectives and rationale are laid out explicitly and are traceable through the Introduction, Theoretical Framework, and Preregistered Hypothesis sections.

Thank you very much for this positive assessment.

Suggestions to Strengthen the Objectives and Rationale

1. Separate primary vs. exploratory objectives explicitly, up front

Currently the objectives for the preregistered hypothesis (H1) are crisp, but the rationale for the exploratory outcomes (categorical non-delegation, win-stay/lose-shift dynamics) is woven in after the fact, in the Results/Discussion. Suggestion: Add a short paragraph at the end of the Introduction or in the "Preregistered hypothesis and analysis plan" section that explicitly states a secondary/exploratory objective, e.g.: "Beyond our confirmatory test of H1, we exploratorily examine whether resistance to personalization is concentrated in a subgroup (categorical non-delegation) and whether authority-based and accuracy-based accounts can be dissociated using post-task expectation data." This gives readers a map of all the paper's aims, not just the confirmatory one, before they hit the results.

Thanks for the suggestion, we added a paragraph at the end of the "Preregistered hypothesis and analysis plan" subsection stating the exploratory objectives (categorical non-delegation; dissociating authority-based from accuracy-based accounts) explicitly, before the results are presented.

2. State the boundary conditions of the claim earlier

The rationale currently implies a fairly general claim ("personalization deters delegation"), but the effect is specifically about first contact and dissipates with feedback. Suggestion: Sharpen the objective statement itself to build this scope condition in from the start, e.g.: "We test whether personalization deters delegation specifically at the point of first contact, before outcome feedback is available, and examine whether this initial resistance persists once experience accumulates." This would prevent the apparent tension later where the abstract implies a broad effect but only one of two primary tests is significant.

We believe the abstract already does this adequately: it states that personalization "did not increase delegation at any point of the task" and then explains that the effect is concentrated at first contact while subsequent-decision rates are statistically indistinguishable, so the scope condition is visible from the first paragraph a reader encounters.

3. Make the rationale for choosing lotteries/financial decisions as the test domain more explicit

The rationale draws heavily on general decision-rights theory but doesn't fully justify why a lottery-choice paradigm is the right operationalization of that theory, beyond one paragraph gesturing at

robo-advisors. Suggestion: Add 2–3 sentences explicitly justifying the task choice: why lotteries (vs. e.g., real financial products, medical decisions) provide a clean test of the construal mechanism — likely because payoffs are unambiguous, preferences are directly elicitable, and EV is objectively computable, allowing the two algorithms to be equated on legitimacy but not on personalization.

We added a new paragraph immediately after the theoretical-framework paragraph explaining why lotteries provide a clean test: payoffs/probabilities are unambiguous (ruling out competence confounds), preferences are directly elicitable and verifiable by the experimenter, and EV is objectively computable, letting the two algorithms be equated on accuracy and legitimacy while differing only in personalization, a contrast real financial or medical decisions could not deliver cleanly.

4. Pre-empt the wording-confound issue in the rationale itself

Since the two algorithm descriptions differ in tone ("works out how much each option would yield on average" vs. "analyses your choices... selects the best option for you"), the rationale should anticipate this as a design choice rather than let readers discover it as a potential confound. Suggestion: Add a sentence acknowledging that the two descriptions were designed to hold length/complexity constant while varying only the personalization cue, and briefly justify why this wording, specifically, was chosen to operationalize "construal."

We now acknowledge this explicitly in the Limitations section (see Question 7 below) rather than letting readers discover it unflagged. We also state that the asymmetry is partly deliberate: in the earlier pilot the preference-based description lacked any optimization claim, so we added "selects the best option for you" in the present study to rule out that the missing optimization claim explained the EV advantage. The first-contact gap remained (11.1 points vs. about 20 in the pilot), so it cannot be attributed fully to that omission. We note that the two studies differ in other respects, so we cannot cleanly attribute the smaller gap to the wording change. The text acknowledges that a difference in register remains.

5. Motivate the non-preregistered categorical non-delegation outcome theoretically before the results, not just descriptively after

Currently, the theoretical link between heterogeneous decision-rights valuation and categorical opt-out is made in the Theoretical Framework section, but its status as a genuine aim of the study (vs. a fortunate post-hoc discovery) would be more convincing if explicitly flagged as a planned-but-unregistered secondary objective in the introduction, with a one-line rationale: "Because the value placed on decision rights is known to be heterogeneous across individuals, we additionally expect resistance to concentrate in a subgroup of high-autonomy-valuing users, manifesting as categorical non-delegation rather than a uniform shift in rates."

We have intentionally not reframed this as something anticipated ex ante in the Introduction, to avoid blurring the line between confirmatory and exploratory analyses. The theoretical link (heterogeneous valuation of decision rights predicting a subgroup structure) is made in the Theoretical Framework section, and the analysis itself is explicitly and repeatedly labeled non-preregistered/exploratory in the Results and in the abstract (see Question 5 below). We think this

strikes the right balance: the theoretical rationale is given, without implying the test was planned in advance.

6. Strengthen the rationale for why the effect should reverse after feedback

The theoretical framework predicts the first-contact effect well but doesn't build in an a priori rationale for why the effect should attenuate with feedback (the "construal dominates early, outcomes dominate later" account emerges mostly in the Discussion). Suggestion: Add this two-stage logic to the theoretical framework section itself, so the null result for average delegation is anticipated by the theory rather than appearing as a post-hoc explanation for a non-result.

Similarly, we have kept the "construal dominates early, outcomes dominate later" logic primarily in the Discussion rather than building it into the a priori theoretical framework, for the same reason: the round-by-round decomposition was not the preregistered test, and presenting its rationale as derived from the theory ex ante would overstate how much of it was anticipated before seeing the data.

7. Tighten the applied rationale with a concrete real-world stat or example

The applied motivation (robo-advisors, healthcare, hiring) is reasonable but currently generic. Suggestion: Cite one concrete adoption statistic or documented case (e.g., a robo-advisor adoption rate, or evidence that personalized recommender opt-out is a documented friction point in a real platform) to ground the applied stakes more concretely and make the rationale less abstract.

We did not find a citable, meaningful robo-advisor "adoption rate" statistic. As your own question implicitly recognizes, non-adoption is rarely observable at the population level in field data, which is precisely the kind of comparison our controlled design is suited to make instead. We have left the applied motivation at its current, intentionally general level rather than citing a number we could not verify.

2. If applicable, is the application/theory/method/study reported in sufficient detail to allow for its replicability and/or reproducibility?

Overall: Mostly yes, with a few notable gaps. The paper is unusually detailed for an experimental psychology/behavioral economics report, but there are specific points where a replicator would have to guess or contact the authors.

Strengths — well-specified elements

1. Preregistration is linked and primary analyses are fully specified.
The preregistration document is available at https://aspredicted.org/7un5qf.pdf, and the primary tests are named precisely: "a one-sided Boschloo exact test for the treatment difference in delegation in round 1," "a one-sided Wilcoxon–Mann–Whitney test comparing participant-level average delegation rates," and a linear probability model with decision-set fixed effects, participant-clustered SEs, and specified interaction terms. This is sufficient for statistical reproducibility in principle.

2. Recruitment, exclusions, and sample size are quantified precisely.
Participant flow is fully accounted for: "We recruited N = 240 participants and then applied preregistered exclusion rules... The final analysis sample is N = 233 (EV condition: n = 118; preference-based condition: n = 115)," with exclusion criteria named (bot/slider checks, comprehension checks, disclosed AI usage, log-time rule, incomplete data).

3. Software/platform is specified with version number.
"Participants completed a two-part experiment programmed in the online-ready version of z-Tree (version 6.0.0 beta 69, Fischbacher, 2007)" — this is good practice and rare in behavioral studies; it allows a replicator to use the identical experimental engine.

4. Task structure, timing, and payoff logic are described in detail, including the 5-second delegation window, 8-second choice window, decoy-option construction, the GBP 2 base payment plus bonus formula, and the anchor/decoy dominance construction logic (Section 3.2, with Figure 1 example).

5. Ethics approval is documented with a verifiable certificate number and URL.

Thank you very much for commending us on these aspects.

Gaps that limit full replicability

1. Data and code are not yet available.
The paper states: "Data, analysis code, and study materials will be deposited in a public repository upon acceptance/publication of this manuscript." Until that repository actually exists and is linked, computational reproducibility (re-running the reported statistics on the raw data) cannot be verified by reviewers or readers. This is the single largest gap — a promise, not a resource.

A full replication package (participant- and decision-level data, the complete analysis script reproducing every statistic and figure in the paper) is being available to the editor and reviewers for this round of review; we note in the manuscript that we do not consent to any of the materials being uploaded to any AI systems unless they are standalone implementations that are hosted on local servers.

2. The exact 12 Part-1 lottery tasks and full Part-2 payoff matrices are not fully reproduced in text. Only one example screen is shown (Figure 1). The complete set of 12 Part-1 binary choices and their mapping rules to the 8 Part-2 tasks (including the "fixed pre-specified rule" for option ordering) are described narratively but not tabulated in an appendix. A replicator would need the exact numeric payoff matrices for all tasks, not just the illustrative one, to reconstruct the instrument exactly.

In addition to the experimental program, we also added the tasks as a new Appendix as suggested. Table A.1 lists all 12 Part-1 binary-choice tasks, and Table A.2 lists all 8 Part-2 option sets (8 options each) actually used in the experiment, including the mapping back to their Part-1 anchor task and an exemplary randomized Part-1/Part-2 presentation order.

3. The full instructions/wording given to participants are only partially quoted.

We see the two algorithm descriptions and a few checks (bicycle image task, attention checks), but the complete verbatim instructions, consent text, and post-task questionnaire items (financial risk-taking scale, satisfaction items, closed-item reason list shown in Figure 4) are not provided in full — e.g., the exact wording and full response options for all items in Figure 4 ("BetterJob," "DislikeRelyingOn," "DontTrust," etc.) are named as variable labels but not given as verbatim survey text.

In addition to the experimental program, the complete participant instructions can also be found in `fullInstructions.pdf` included in the program folder of the replication package. For the specific closed-item reason labels in Figure 4 (`DontTrust`, `BetterJob`, etc.), we added the full verbatim wording of each item directly to the figure caption, so a reader no longer has to infer meaning from variable-name shorthand.

4. The exact decoy-construction rule and display-order algorithm are described qualitatively, not formally.
"The within-task display order of the eight options was set using a fixed pre-specified rule rather than per-task randomization... the ordering rule was different between option sets" — this describes that a rule existed without specifying what the rule was. A replicator could not reconstruct the exact stimulus display order from this description alone.
The exact fixed display-order rule is now fully specified via the new appendix tables.

5. Details of the regression specifications could be more explicit.
The preregistered regression is described narratively ("treatment indicators interacted with the decision period, decision-ID fixed effects, and participant-clustered standard errors... including the share of zero outcomes among prior delegated choices") but no formal equation is given. A model equation (even in an appendix) would remove ambiguity about functional form and exact covariate coding.
Added. Section 3.5 ("Preregistered outcomes and analyses") now states the exact LPM specification as an equation.

Recommendation: Before publication, the authors should (a) deposit the promised data/code/materials repository and confirm the link is live prior to final acceptance rather than "upon acceptance," (b) include a supplementary appendix with the complete set of Part-1 and Part-2 payoff matrices and the exact decoy/ordering algorithm, and (c) provide the full verbatim questionnaire/instruction text (or a supplementary materials file) rather than narrative paraphrase. These are modest additions relative to the paper's existing level of rigor and would move it from "largely reproducible in principle" to "fully reproducible in practice."

We are optimistic that we do comply with full reproducibility now.

3. If applicable, are statistical analyses, controls, sampling mechanism, and statistical reporting (e.g., P-values, CIs, effect sizes) appropriate and well described?

Yes [X] No [] N/A []
Provide further comments here:

Overall: Reasonably rigorous and mostly well-described, but with meaningful gaps in effect-size and interval reporting, and some under-addressed multiple-comparison issues.

Notable gaps

1. No confidence intervals are reported anywhere in the paper.
Every result is reported as a point estimate/percentage with a p-value and (for regressions) a standard error — e.g., "delegation was higher in the EV condition than in the preference-based condition (66.9% vs. 55.8%)... p = 0.0413" — but never with a CI on the difference in proportions or on regression coefficients. This is a real deficiency by current reporting standards; CIs would let readers judge the precision and plausible range of effects (e.g., how large or small the true first-contact gap might be), which matters given some effects are only marginally significant.

We computed effect sizes and confidence intervals from the raw session data for all three primary/secondary results and added them to the text:

- Round-1 delegation: risk difference 11.1 pp (Wald 95% CI [−1.3, 23.7]); OR = 1.60 (Fisher's exact two-sided 95% CI [0.91, 2.84]). We stick to the standard convention of reporting two-sided CIs despite our one-sided hypotheses and briefly discuss the apparent `contradiction' of CIs including zero/one and the significant one-sided preregistered test.

- Average delegation (WMW): rank-biserial r ≈ 0.05 (bootstrap 95% CI [−0.10, 0.20]), i.e., a small effect whose CI comfortably spans zero, consistent with the null result.

- Categorical non-delegation: risk difference 12.3 pp (Wald 95% CI [4.9, 19.7]); OR = 5.25 (Fisher's exact 95% CI [1.65, 22.07]).

2. No standardized effect sizes are reported.
Raw percentage-point differences (e.g., 15.7% vs. 3.4% never-delegators) are informative but the paper never reports odds ratios, risk ratios, Cohen's h/d, or similar standardized measures that would allow comparison across studies or against the earlier pilot (which is explicitly compared narratively — "about 20 percentage points" — but not statistically benchmarked with a common effect-size metric).

See above: Risk differences and odds ratios are now reported for all three key contrasts.

3. Multiple comparisons in the never-delegator characterization are not corrected or explicitly flagged.
Section 4.4 runs roughly eight separate comparisons (age, income, education, time spent, gender, risk tolerance, response reliability, AI use frequency, satisfaction) between delegators and never-delegators without correction. Since most are null, the practical risk is limited, but the paper should acknowledge this as an exploratory family of tests subject to inflated Type-I error, especially given the very small never-delegator subgroup in the EV condition (n=4).

We have not added an additional, separate multiple-comparisons caveat here, because the existing power caveat (new limitations text, see Question 4 below) already does the necessary work: it tells the reader that this entire family of comparisons is underpowered and that null results should not be over-interpreted, which is the more binding constraint in a sample of 22 never-delegators (18 vs. 4 by condition). We are happy to add an explicit multiple-comparisons sentence as well if it still seems necessary.

4. Sample size/power justification is not stated.
"The preregistered target was 120 participants per treatment condition" is given, but no power analysis or effect-size assumption underlying this target is reported (e.g., was 120/cell powered to detect the ~20-point gap seen in the unregistered pilot study?). Given the confirmed effect (p=.041) is only modestly significant with N≈233, a stated power calculation would help readers judge whether the design was adequately powered — especially relevant since the second primary test (Wilcoxon, p=.24) was null.

We conducted a power analysis based on the pilot study (with effect sizes of 21.6 percentage points for the first-round effect, and 19.1 percentage points overall). Using that data gave us a minimum detectable effect at 80% power of 16-17.3 percentage points (first round) and 10-11 percentage points (overall) for one-sided tests and 100-120 observations per treatment. Thus, from what we knew at the time, the tests were adequately powered. Now, the effects we actually observed were clearly smaller (11.1 percentage points for first contact, and none at all for the rest of the rounds). We discuss this power analysis as a new Limitations paragraph.

The power analysis is now reported in a new appendix (Appendix C), with a two-sentence summary in the Limitations section. From the information that was available before the present study was run (the pilot's effect sizes: 21.6pp at first contact, 19.1pp in average delegation), the minimum detectable effect at 80% power for 100–120 participants per arm is ~16–17pp (first contact) and ~10–11pp (average delegation) — both comfortably below the pilot's observed gaps, so the design looked adequately powered ex ante. The first-contact effect that materialized (11.1pp) fell below the ex-ante detection threshold, which we offer as a plausible, purely descriptive explanation for why that result is significant only under the preregistered one-sided versions of the tests. We do not compute a "power" figure for the realized 11.1pp effect itself, since retrospective power computed from a study's own observed effect is a well-documented statistical fallacy (Hoenig & Heisey, 2001), being a deterministic function of the p-value not adding any information. For the null average-delegation result, ex-ante power was very high (99.7–99.9% for an effect of the pilot's size), so we explicitly do *not* invoke power to explain that null; instead we point to the regression evidence and the round-by-round pattern showing genuine convergence to zero after round 1.

5. Interpretation of borderline p-values could be more measured.
The primary round-1 result (p=.0413, one-sided) and the round-1-only regression check reported in a footnote (p=.041, one-sided) both sit close to the conventional threshold. The paper treats these as confirmatory support without discussing the sensitivity of the conclusion to this proximity to α=.05, particularly given one-sided testing effectively halves the bar relative to two-sided convention.

We have not added a dedicated discussion of "sensitivity to the 0.05 threshold" for the round-1 result: we personally do not treat alpha = 0.05 as a privileged cutoff whose proximity requires special comment (even though we sometimes tend to use the conventional “yes-or-no” language in writing), and we would not have wanted to add a symmetric discussion to the text had the one-sided p-value instead been 0.059. We think the effect-size/CI reporting added above already gives readers everything they need to judge the evidential strength of the result directly, which we see as the more informative response to this concern than hedging around the significance threshold itself.

6. Small-cell caveats are inconsistently applied.
The authors appropriately caution that the EV never-delegator subgroup (n=4) is too small to interpret for one contrast ("we do not interpret, because the EV never-delegator subgroup comprises

only four participants") but do not apply the same caution systematically elsewhere where n=4 findings might implicitly support the argument (e.g., in the closed-item reason figure discussion, Figure 4, where this subgroup's bars are still shown and discussed).

On re-inspection, we confirmed this caution was in fact already applied consistently: the one place the EV-condition never-delegator subgroup's pattern is visually present (Figure 4) is explicitly flagged in the surrounding text ("we do not interpret [this contrast], because the EV never-delegator subgroup comprises only four participants"), and no interpretive claim anywhere in the paper relies on that subgroup specifically — all interpreted contrasts in that subsection compare delegators to never-delegators pooled across treatments. We have made that clearer in the text so that now, no confusion should be possible around that issue any longer.

7. Assumption checks are not reported for t-tests.
Multiple independent-samples t-tests are used (e.g., age, satisfaction, expectation comparisons) without reporting whether normality/variance-homogeneity assumptions were checked, or whether a robustness check (e.g., Welch's correction, non-parametric equivalent) was used — though the parallel reporting of Wilcoxon rank-sum alongside some t-tests (e.g., the expectation-data comparison) suggests some attentiveness to this.

The relevant subsection now includes a footnote confirming that (a) all reported t-tests use the Welch correction for unequal variances, and (b) every null finding in that subsection is also confirmed by the non-parametric Wilcoxon rank-sum equivalent (age: p=0.649; time in experiment: p=0.105; risk-taking: p=0.854; reliability: p=0.956; AI experience: p=0.445).

4. Could the manuscript benefit from additional tables or figures, or from improving or removing (some of the) existing ones?
Suggestions for Tables and Figures

Add a summary table of the two primary preregistered tests and their results. Currently the Boschloo test, Wilcoxon test, and regression coefficients are reported only in running text across several paragraphs (Sections 4.2–4.3). A single table listing: test name, outcome variable, comparison, statistic, p-value, and (once added, per earlier suggestions) effect size and CI would let readers see at a glance which of the primary hypotheses were confirmed and which were null, directly supporting the transparency this preregistered design deserves.

Thank you for your suggestion, we added it as Table 1 (in the new Results "Overview" subsection).

Add a participant flow / CONSORT-style diagram or table for recruitment and exclusions. The text states 240 recruited, various exclusion criteria applied, 233 retained, split 118/115 — but the breakdown of how many were excluded for each criterion (bot/slider failure, comprehension failure, disclosed AI use, log-time rule, incomplete data) is not shown. A simple flow diagram or table would improve transparency and let readers assess whether exclusions were balanced across conditions.

The exact breakdown of the 7 excluded participants by criterion (1 bot/slider failure, 4 careful-participation failures, 3 disclosed-AI-usage cases, with noted overlaps) is in the Method section. We have not added a separate visual flow diagram, since with only 7 exclusions split across two conditions we do not think a diagram adds clarity beyond the prose breakdown; we would also

gently push back on reading anything into whether such small exclusion counts are "balanced" across conditions: With numbers this low, noisy imbalances in percentage terms would be expected under pure chance and are not informative about differential exclusion bias.

Add a table (or expand Figure 1) showing the full set of Part-1 and Part-2 payoff matrices, not just the single illustrative example currently shown in Figure 1. This is important for both interpretability and replicability (as raised in the reproducibility review) — an appendix table listing all 12 Part-1 tasks and their mapping to the 8 Part-2 decision sets would let readers evaluate task difficulty/dominance structure directly rather than trusting the narrative description.

Added as the new Appendix (Tables A.1–A.2; see Question 2 above).

Add confidence intervals/error bars consistently and label them clearly across all figures. Figure 2 already shows "95%-confidence bands" as whiskers, which is good — but Figure 3 (ECDF) and Figure 4 (bar chart of reasons) show no uncertainty indication at all. At minimum, Figure 4 should include error bars or CIs on the click-rate percentages, since several of the between-subgroup comparisons discussed in text (e.g., 70.1% vs. 36.4%) rely on this figure and readers cannot currently gauge precision visually.

We have added CIs to the text wherever a precise estimate is discussed (see point 3), but have not added error bars to Figure 3 (the ECDF) or Figure 4 (the reasons bar chart), for reasons specific to each: an ECDF already displays the full empirical distribution of every participant's average delegation rate, so there is no separate "uncertainty" to overlay without changing what the figure shows; and the between-subgroup percentages discussed in the text around Figure 4 (e.g., 70.1% vs. 36.4%) are comparisons of all delegators vs. all never-delegators pooled across treatments, whereas the figure itself is split by treatment (we added a clarifying sentence to the text noting this distinction explicitly, since this discrepancy, rather than the absence of error bars, was the more likely source of confusion).

Improve Figure 4's labeling and readability. The x-axis item labels ("BetterJob," "DislikeRelyingOn," "DontTrust," "HowExactly," "MoreInfo," "PerformanceCuriosity," "Reactance2Analysis," "Responsibility4Choice," "Responsibility4Outcome," "Tedious") are internal variable names rather than reader-facing text. These should be replaced with the actual (or closely paraphrased) item wording or a clear one-line legend/footnote translating each code, since the reader currently has to infer meaning from variable-name shorthand.

We agree, the full verbatim wording of each closed-item reason is now given in the figure caption (see Question 2 above).

5. If applicable, are the interpretation of results and study conclusions supported by the data?

Reviewer #1: Mark as appropriate with an X:
Yes [X] No [] N/A []
Provide further comments here:
Overall: Largely yes, with the authors showing commendable restraint in several places — but there are specific points where the interpretive language outpaces what the data can bear, particularly around the "core finding" framing, the authority-based mechanism claim, and the strength of the categorical non-delegation story.

Recalibrate the abstract and title to reflect that only one of two preregistered primary tests was confirmatory. Consider revising the abstract's framing from "personalization did not increase delegation at any point of the task; instead, it deterred delegation in two ways" to something like: "personalization reduced delegation at first contact; this effect did not persist across repeated decisions, and personalization was additionally associated with substantially more categorical non-delegation (exploratory analysis)." This preserves the interesting findings while accurately signaling which result is confirmatory and which is exploratory.

We have kept the abstract's core sentence ("Personalization did not increase delegation at any point of the task...") as is: we believe it is accurate rather than overclaiming, since the theoretical prior (based on the personalized algorithm's higher expected utility) was that personalization *should* have increased delegation, and the finding that it did not, combined with it actively *decreasing* delegation at two distinct margins, is precisely what the sentence reports. We have, however, made the targeted change below.

Add an explicit statement in the abstract/title-adjacent framing that categorical non-delegation was a non-preregistered, exploratory outcome. Currently this is disclosed in the body text but not in the abstract or highlights, where it carries equal billing with the confirmed first-contact effect. A brief parenthetical ("in an exploratory analysis") in the abstract would resolve this.

Done, we explicitly added "exploratory analysis" to the categorical non-delegation figures.

Soften the declarative language around "authority-based resistance" in the Discussion and Contributions sections (5.1–5.3, 5.6) to match the hedging already present in the Limitations section. For example, phrases like "our evidence isolates a second, conceptually distinct channel: authority-based resistance" could be revised to "our evidence is consistent with a second, conceptually distinct channel: authority-based resistance" or "...points toward authority-based resistance as the more plausible remaining account." This would align the confidence level of the Discussion with the appropriately cautious framing already used in Section 5.4 ("a direct manipulation of authority salience remains for future work").

Thank you for the suggestion, which we followed: "our evidence isolates a second, conceptually distinct channel" now reads "our evidence is most consistent with a second, conceptually distinct channel," aligning the Discussion's confidence level with the hedging already present in the Limitations section.

Directly address the tension between the "not accuracy-based" conclusion and the self-reported distrust data in Section 4.6. Never-delegators selected "general distrust of the algorithm" more often than delegators (50.0% vs. 32.2%), which sits somewhat awkwardly next to the paper's central claim that resistance isn't accuracy-based. Consider expanding the existing parenthetical rebuttal into a fuller paragraph that reconciles the expectation data (which rule out accuracy concerns) with the closed-item "distrust" reason (which seems to invoke accuracy), perhaps by distinguishing "distrust of accuracy" from "distrust of the delegation act itself" as separate constructs that the closed-item wording may conflate.

We expanded the parenthetical into a full paragraph distinguishing distrust of the algorithm's accuracy (which our quantitative expectation data speak to directly and rule out) from a more diffuse distrust of ceding the choice to any external party (which the single closed-item wording plausibly also picks up without distinguishing the two). We note this as a conflation in the item's

wording rather than a contradiction in the evidence, and flag a cleaner closed-item design as a direction for future work.

Temper the real-world generalization claims in Section 5.5 to more explicitly match the single-domain, stylized, time-pressured lottery task used. Consider adding a qualifying sentence before extending to robo-advisors, healthcare, and hiring contexts, such as: "These extensions are speculative given the abstract and time-constrained nature of our task, and we offer them as hypotheses for domain-specific replication rather than established implications."

We followed your suggestion, using language close to your suggested wording: we added a sentence stating explicitly that the robo-advisor/healthcare/hiring extensions "are speculative given the abstract, single-domain, and time-constrained nature of our lottery task" and are offered as hypotheses for domain-specific replication rather than established implications.

Apply small-cell caution consistently across the paper. The EV never-delegator subgroup (n=4) is explicitly flagged as too small to interpret in the always-delegator comparison (Section 4.4) but is still discussed and shown in Figure 4 without the same caveat. Consider adding a brief note wherever this subgroup appears in interpretive text (not just in the figure caption) reminding readers of its size.

As noted under Question 3 above, we checked and confirmed the EV never-delegator subgroup (n=4) is not relied upon for any interpretive claim beyond the one place it is already explicitly flagged.

6. Have the authors clearly emphasized the strengths of their study/theory/methods/argument?

Partially.
The authors do highlight some strengths (preregistration, incentivized behavior, the accuracy/authority dissociation), but several genuine methodological strengths are underplayed or left implicit, buried in method details rather than surfaced as selling points in the Introduction/Discussion where reviewers and readers form their overall impression. Below are specific, numbered suggestions for where and how to better foreground these strengths.

Thank you very much for this detailed and encouraging assessment. It is genuinely useful to know which specific design choices came through as intended.

Suggestions for Tables and Figures

(...)

All the suggestions were already provided elsewhere in the review, so that we refrain from reproducing them (as well as our responses) here.

7. Have the authors clearly stated the limitations of their study/theory/methods/argument?

The authors do include a dedicated Limitations section (5.4) and scattered caveats throughout (e.g., on the exploratory status of categorical non-delegation, the ex-post nature of the reason data). This is a genuine strength. However, several substantive limitations raised earlier in this review are either

missing entirely, underemphasized, or mentioned only in passing rather than in the dedicated Limitations section where a reader would expect to find them. Below is a consolidated, numbered list of limitations the authors should add or emphasize more clearly.

We have substantially expanded the Limitations section with seven distinct points (up from three; the numbering in the manuscript is First to Seventh), incorporating essentially every substantive gap you identified:

1. (Existing, expanded) Stylized task domain: clarified that Part-2 choices were real and incentivized, with the stylization limited to the task domain rather than to the incentive structure.

2. (Existing, expanded) Mechanism not causally identified, plus two new additions directly responding to this review: (a) an explicit acknowledgment that the two algorithm descriptions differ in linguistic register as well as decision rule, with the deliberate addition of an optimization claim to the preference-based description (making the comparison more conservative relative to the pilot) offered as evidence against a purely wording-driven account; and (b), see “Fourth”

3. (New, "Third") The EV and preference-based treatments differ along several dimensions at once, so the design identifies a difference between two decision rules, not a pure personalization effect (added in response to Reviewer 2).

4. (New, “Fourth”) An explicit discussion of whether low self-chosen choice quality (~35% non-dominated) could confound the choice-authority interpretation. We show never-delegators' own choice quality is statistically indistinguishable from that of delegators (Welch $p=0.806$; Wilcoxon $p=0.669$), arguing against a task-difficulty account of categorical non-delegation specifically.

5. (Existing, renumbered "Fifth") Short-run repeated interaction only.

6. (New, "Sixth") The ex-ante power analysis described under Question 3 above, summarized in two sentences in the Limitations and reported in full in Appendix C.

7. (New, "Seventh") UK/Prolific sample: we note explicitly that cultural background, algorithm familiarity, and panel composition could affect the magnitude (though we have no principled reason to expect the direction) of the effect.

8. Does the manuscript structure, flow or writing need improving (e.g., the addition of subheadings, shortening of text, reorganization of sections, or moving details from one section to another)?

Yes.
The manuscript is generally well-organized and follows a logical IMRaD structure, but there are several places where reorganization, subheadings, or relocation of content would improve readability and reduce redundancy. Below are specific, numbered suggestions.

Suggestions to Authors
Add subheadings within Section 4.6 ("Exploratory mechanisms"). This section already has implicit sub-questions ("Did participants trust the personalized algorithm to match their preferences?" and "What distinguishes delegators from never-delegators?") formatted as bolded run-in headers, but a third distinct question is answered ("Which expectations are most tightly linked to delegation...")

without a clear corresponding header. Formalizing all three as numbered or lettered subheadings (matching the three questions explicitly posed at the start of 4.6) would make this dense section much easier to navigate.

Thank you for that suggestion, we added the missing third subheading ("Which expectations are most tightly linked to delegation?") so all three questions posed at the start of the subsection now have a matching, explicit header.

Move the detailed Part-1/Part-2 task-construction description (decoy options, anchor transformation, display-order rules) out of the main Method text and into a supplementary/appendix section, retaining only a brief summary in Section 3.2. This material (roughly a full page) is important for replicability but is dense and procedural; relocating the fine-grained construction logic (e.g., "the within-task display order of the eight options was set using a fixed pre-specified rule...") to an appendix would let Section 3.2 focus on the conceptual design while preserving full detail for replicators.

We have left the narrative description in the main Method text given that we were afraid that the other reviewers would oppose this change (and we ourselves would expect a `full' description in the main text).

Consolidate the repeated statements of the paper's contribution. The core contribution is restated in very similar language at least four times: end of Introduction ("The contribution is fourfold..."), end of Section 2.7 ("Synthesis and contribution"), Section 5.1 ("Core finding"), and Section 5.6 ("Contributions"). Consider trimming Section 2.7's contribution restatement (it largely duplicates the Introduction's) and ensuring Section 5.6 adds genuinely new synthesis rather than repeating the same four points a third/fourth time in near-identical wording.

We agree and have consolidated. The Introduction now holds the single explicit contribution list, reduced from four to three points (the preregistered comparison and its concentration at first contact are merged; the authority- versus accuracy-based separation is stated with the hedged wording used elsewhere). Section 2.7 is retitled "Synthesis and research gap" and no longer lists what the study examines. The opening restatement in the "Interpretation and relation to prior work" subsection was deleted. The separate "Contributions" subsection of the Discussion was removed; its one non-duplicative point (adoption-stage resistance versus error-driven withdrawal during use, observed in exploratory analyses) now closes the "Theoretical implications" subsection. "Core finding" is kept as the normal opening of the Discussion.

9. Could the manuscript benefit from language editing?

Yes

Sorry to hear that you were not happy with the writing. Beyond the AI-assisted language support already disclosed in the "Declaration of generative AI" subsection, we ran an additional proofreading pass before resubmission by a native speaker.

Strenghts:
1. Innovative focus on the nature of the decision rule as a primary deterrent to delegation, moving

beyond traditional trust-based or performance-based models.

2. Rigorous methodological isolation of 'first-contact' delegation in the section titled 'Method,' which effectively prevents feedback contamination from confounding initial behavioral tendencies.

3. Compelling empirical evidence in the 'Results' section showing that users acknowledge the superior accuracy of personalized algorithms while simultaneously refusing to use them.

4. Strong adherence to open science standards, including a preregistered experimental design and the identification of a distinct 'categorical non-delegator' subgroup.

Thank you very much for these encouraging comments.

Weaknesses:
Theoretical omission of Psychological Ownership:
The 'Theoretical framework' fails to address the paradox where personalization typically increases engagement, missing contemporary literature like the 'AI Ghostwriter Effect' that could explain why preference-based rules feel like a substitution rather than an extension of the self.

We appreciate this pointer to a related literature. We have not built a new theoretical subsection around it, but the Discussion ("Interpretation and relation to prior work") now states that a psychological-ownership account is compatible with ours and cites Draxler et al. (2024, the AI Ghostwriter Effect). We note the limits of that evidence: it concerns text generation, and personalization did not alter ownership there, so it does not directly predict our result. We list ownership measures as future work.

Unexplored Responsibility Trap:
The analysis overlooks 'responsibility offloading' as a driver; objective rules may be preferred because they provide a neutral 'third party' to blame for failure, whereas personalized rules may leave the user feeling solely responsible for algorithmic errors.

We added a paragraph to the Discussion that addresses this account explicitly and cites Maasland & Weißmüller (2022), who find that blame avoidance is a weak motive for delegation relative to algorithm aversion, and Gogoll & Uhl (2018), who find that reluctance to delegate to a machine is not explained by perceived utility, trust, or a lower ability to pass on responsibility (again with the caveat that everyone had to delegate to someone, so the design compares agents rather than delegating vs. deciding oneself). We acknowledge that we did not measure anticipated blame directly. The account is also already represented in our design and results: the closed-item reasons include two responsibility-related items ("I didn't want to be responsible for choosing the option" and "I didn't want to be responsible if a low payment results"). Note that the choice-responsibility item is worded according to the hypothetical choice (participants who decide themselves can say they wanted to be responsible, participants who delegate can say they did not want to be), so the pooled comparison of never-delegators with the rest (63.6% vs. 38.9%) largely contrasts reasons for deciding oneself with reasons for delegating. The hypothetical choice closely mirrors actual behavior (91% of never-delegators decide themselves, 95% of always-delegators delegate; Spearman correlation with the Part-2 delegation share 0.68). The text now reports the within-choice

figures: 66.4% of those who decide themselves say they wanted to be responsible, and 16.2% of those who delegate say they did not want to be (about one in four endorse either responsibility item). We read this as responsibility for the choice being the dominant stated reason for deciding oneself, with a minority of delegators citing responsibility avoidance, so some responsibility shifting among delegators is not excluded. We added a note to the Figure 4 caption and to Section 4.6 explaining how the item reads, and we no longer present the pooled contrast as evidence for a never-delegator-specific motive.

Severe structural and presentational artifacts:
The manuscript contains incomplete sentences in the 'Abstract,' multiple typographical errors in headers (e.g., 'Reoretical'), and fragmented text/formatting errors in the 'References' section that hinder readability.
We carefully checked the current manuscript for each of these specific issues and did not find them: the abstract contains no incomplete sentences, we found no more typos, and we did not identify fragmented formatting in the references.

Insufficient statistical reporting for core claims:
The claim of a 'distinct acceptance barrier' for categorical non-delegators lacks explicit significance testing (e.g., Fisher's Exact test) in the 'Results' section, and the mechanism for 'zero-outcome' frequency in the EV condition is insufficiently supported.

Thank you once more for these pointers. We added an explicit significance test (a one-sided Boschloo exact test, $p < 0.001$; two-sided $p = 0.001$) directly to the sentence introducing the categorical non-delegation contrast, alongside the risk-difference/OR effect sizes described under Question 3 above. We use the same test as for our preregistered first-contact comparison; since this outcome was not preregistered, we flag the test as exploratory in the text and in Table 1.

We agree also with respect to the zero-outcome mechanism, and we have removed the claim. The submitted version stated that the EV algorithm mechanically produces more zero-payoff outcomes for most participants (89.7%, computed from the payoff structure), and used this to explain the post-round-1 convergence. That figure only says that the EV pick has more expected zeros for most participants; it does not say how much more, and the realized data show a small difference (40.3% vs. 36.2% of delegated decisions, participant-clustered p = 0.178; expected 41.7% vs. 34.8%). The text now reports this comparison, drops the 89.7% figure and the "EV loses it more" inference, and replaces them with an explicitly exploratory decomposition (see our reply to Reviewer 3, Question 3). The expected-zero calculation relies on the ten states of each lottery being equally likely, which is a feature of the task design; the Method section now states this where the lotteries are first introduced.